



Most Common Roots, Prefixes, & Suffixes

Word Part	Meaning	Examples
ab	away	absent, abduct, abnormal, abort
acer (acid)	bitter, sour	acerb, acerbate, acidity
acro	top, height	acrobat, acronym, acrophobia
acu	sharp	acute, acupressure, acupuncture, acuity
aer	air, atmosphere	aerosol, aeroplane
agri	farming	agriculture, agrarian
alb	white	albino, albumen, albacore
amb	around, both	ambient, ambiguous, amble
ambul	walk, move	amble, ambulance, ambulant
amic	friendly	amicable, amicably, dynamic
anim	life, living	animal, animate, equanimity
ann (enn)	year	anniversary, annual, millennium
ante	before	antemortem, antebellum
anthro	human	anthropology, philanthropist
anti (ant)	against, opposite	antagonist, antidote, antibiotics
aqu	water	aquarium, aquifer
arbor	tree	arborist, harbored, arborize
arche (archi)	primitive, origin	archaic, archaeology, archive
arthr	joint	arthroscope, arthritis, arthropod
astro	star	astronaut, astronomy, astrogate
audi	hearing, sound	auditory, auditorium, audience
auto	self	autopilot, autonomous, automatic
avi	bird	aviator, aviary, aviatrix
bel	war, fight	rebel, antebellum
bene	good	benefit, benign, benevolent, benefactor
bi	two	bicycle, biceps, biscotti, biweekly
biblio	book	bibliography, bibliophile
bio	life	biology, biological, biography
blast	cell, primitive	blastula, fibroblast, blastoderm
bon	good	bonus, bonanza
cap	head	capital, decapitate, captain
capt (cept)	take hold of	captivate, intercept, capture
cardi	heart	cardiac, cardiologist, cardiovascular
cata	intensive, accordi	cataclysm, catastrophic, catalog
caust (caut)	to burn	cauterize, holocaust
cede (cess, ced)	go, withdraw	recede, exceed, recession
ceive	take	receive, perceive, reconceive
cent	hundred	centennial, century, percent

cerebr	brain	cerebral, cerebrated
cert	sure	certain, ascertain, certify
chron	time	chronicle, chronology
cide	kill	genocide, pesticide
circum	around	circumference, circumstance
clam (claim)	shout, speak	exclaim, clamor, proclaim
clar	clear	clarify, clarification, declare
clud (clus)	close	conclusion, seclude, conclude
clin (cline)	lean	inclination, incline, recline
co	with, together, join	coauthor, cosign, collaborate, cooperate
cog	know	cognitive, incognito, cognition
con	together, common	connect, convention, concur
contra	against	contraband, contrary
corp	body	corporation, corpse, corporal
cosm	world	cosmic, microcosm
counter	opposing, contrary	counteract, counterintuitive, counteroffer
cracy (crat)	government, authority	democracy, democrat, theocracy, bureaucracy
cred	believe	incredible, credit, credulous, credence
crypt	hidden, secret	cryptic, encrypt
culp	blame, fault	culpable, exculpate, culprit
cumul	mass, heap	accumulate, cumulative
cycle	circle	bicycle, cyclone, cyclist
dec (deka)	ten	decade, decimal, decathlon
dem	people	democracy, demographics
dent	tooth	dentist, dentistry, dentifrice
derma	skin	dermatologist, hypodermic, dermatitis, pachyderm
di	twice, two	dilemma, diverse, dioxide
dia	across, through	dialogue, diameter, diagnosis
dic (dict)	speak	dictate, dictator, contradict
domin	master	dominate, predominate, dominion
don	give	donate, pardon, donor
dorm	sleep	dormitory, dormant, dormer
dur	harden, long lasting	durable, duration, endure
dyn	power, energy	dynamite, dynamic
ego	self	egotistical, egomania
ence (ance)	state, condition	performance, conference, insurance
endo	within, inside	endocrine, endometrial
esth (aesth)	beauty, feeling	esthetician, aesthetic, kinesthesia
ethn	nation, race	ethnicity, ethnology, ethnocentric
eu	good, well	euphemism, euphoria
ex	out, former	exit, ex-girlfriend, exterminate, extract
extra	beyond	extraordinary, extraterrestrial, extravagance
fac	make, do	artifact, factory, factor, malefactor
famil	a close attendant	family, familiar

femin	woman	feminism, feminine
fend (fens)	strike	offend, offense, defend, defense
fer	carry, bring	transfer, ferry, conifer, confer
fid	trust	confidence, fidelity
flect (flex)	bend	reflect, flexible, inflect, deflect
foli	leaf	foliage, defoliant
fore	in front of, previous	before, therefore, forebode, forecast
fract (frag)	to break	fracture, fragment, fraction
fug	flee, escape	refugee, fugitive, refuge
fum	smoke	fumes, fumigation
fusc	dark	obfuscation, infusate, subfuscous, fuscous
gen	family, born	genetics, generation, gender, gene
geo	earth	geography, geology
ger	old age	geriatrics, gerontology
giga	A billion	gigabyte, gigawatt
gon	angle	polygon, decagon, octagon, hexagon
grad (gress)	to step, to go	digress, gradual, graduate
gram	writing	grammar, grammatically
graph	write	paragraph, autograph
grat	pleasing	gratification, gratitude, grateful
grav (griev)	heavy	gravity, grave, aggravate, greive
gymn	bare	gymnast, gymnastics, gymnosperm
gyn	woman	gynecology, androgynous, misogyny
hab (hib)	have	habit, habitual, prohibition, exhibit
helio	sun	heliograph, heliometer, perihelion
hemo	blood	hemorrhage, hemoglobin, hemophiliac
hepa	liver	hepatitis, hepatoma, hepatotoxic
herbi	grass, plant	herbivore, herbicide, herbal
hex	six	hexagon, hexapod, hexameter
hiero	sacred, holy	hierarchy, hieroglyphics
histo	tissue	histology, histogenesis, histochemical
homo (homeo)	same, alike	homogeneous, homonym, homeopath
hosp	guest	hospital, hospice, hospitable
host	enemy, stranger	hostage, hostile
hydra	water	hydrate, hydraulic
hyper	over, beyond	hyperactive, hyperventilate
hypno	sleep	hypnotic, hypnosis
hypo	under	hypothermic, hypothesis, hypoglycemia
ian	related to	librarian, historian, pedestrian
iatr	medical care	geriatrics, pediatrics, podiatrist
icon	image	iconic, iconology
ideo	idea	ideology, ideologue, ideologic
idio	peculiar, distinct	idiotic, idiomatic
in (il)	not	incapable, incomplete, informal, illegal, illogical

infra	beneath	infrastructure, infrared	
init	to begin or enter	initiate, initiation, initiative, initial	
inter	between	interview, international, interstate	
ir	not	irrational, irredeemable, irrelevant, irregular, irresponsible	
iso	equal	isobar, isometric	
ject	throw, push	eject, reject, interject	
jud	law	judicial, judge, judgement	
junct	join	conjunction, junction, disjunctions	
juven	young	juvenile, rejuvenate	
kilo	thousand	kilobyte, kilometer, kilogram	
kine	movement	telekinesis, kinetic, kinesthetic	
lab	work	elaborate, laboratory, laborious, labor, collaborate	
lat	broad, wide	dilate, latitude	
later	side	bilateral, unilateral	
laud	praise	laudably, applause, applaud	
lax	not tense	relax, relaxation, laxness, laxative	
less	without	homeless, useless, wireless, restless	
lev	lift	elevator, levitate, level	
lex	word, law	lexicology, dyslexic, alexia	
liber	free	liberty, liberate, libertine	
lingu	language	bilingual, linguistics, linguist	
lipo	fat	liposuction, lipase	
lith (lite, ite)	mineral, rock, fossil	appatite, granite, monolith	
liter	letter	alliteration, literate, literal, literacy	
loc	place	location, discolate, relocate	
locu (loqu)	speak	loquacious, eloquent	
log (logy)	study, speech	logic, dialogue, monologue	
longus	long	longevity, longitude	
luc	light	elucidate, lucid, translucent	
lud (lus)	to play, display	prelude, illusion, delude, allude	
lumin	light	illumination, illuminate, luminol, lumen	
macro	large, great	macroeconomics, macronutrients, macroevolution	
maj	greater	majority, majesty, major	
mal	bad, evil	malice, maltreat, malfeasance	
man	hand	manicure, manual, manager, maneuver	
mand	to order	mandate, mandatory, command, demand	
mania	madness, excess	egomania, maniac, hypermania	
mar	sea	marine, marina, maritime, aquamarine	
mater (matr)	mother	maternity, maternal, matriarch, matrimony	
max	greatest	maximum, maximize	
medi	middle	mediocre, medium, medieval	
mega	large	megaphone, megastructure, megadose	
melan	black, dark	melancholy, melanoma, melodrama	
memor	remember	commemorate, memory, memorial	

merge	dip, dive	immerge, submerge
meso	middle	Mesoamerica, meson
meta	change, beyond, &	metaphysics, metamorphosis, metastasis
meter	measure	diameter, thermometer
micro	small	microscope, micronutrient
mid	middle	midway, midterm, midpoint, midweek
migr	move	immigrant, emigrate, migrant, migration
milli	one thousandth	millimeter, millibar, millileter
min	small	minimum, miniature, mini-mart, minute
mir	amazement	miraculous, mirage
mis	wrong, bad	mistake, misprint, misinterpret, misbehave
miss (mit)	send, cast	remit, dismiss, missile, emit
mob	move	mobilize, immobilize, mobility
mon	warn	summon, admonish, premonition, monitor
mort	death	mortuary, immortal, mortify
mot (mov)	move	motion, motivate, remove, moveable
multi	many	multicultural, multigrain, multimedia, multicolored
mut	to change	mutate, mutation
my	muscle	myocardium, myosin, myasthenia
narr	tell	narrator, narration, narrative
nat	born	innate, natural, natal
naut	ship	nautical, astronaut, argonaut
neg	no	negate, negative, renege
neur	nerve	neuralgia, neurologist, nerves, neurotic
neo	new	neophyte, neonatal, neologistic, neocolonialism
nomin	to name	nominate, misnomer, nominal, nomination
non	not	nonviolent, nonstop, nonrefundable
not	note, paper	notable, noteworthy
noun	declare	announce, denounce, announcement
nov	new	novice, renovate, novelty
null	none	nullify, nullification, nulliparity
numer	number	numeral, numerical, enumerate, numerous
ob (op)	in the way, against	object, objection, opposition, obscure
oct	eight	octopus, octagon, octave
ocu	eye, sight	oculist, binoculars, monocula
omni	all	omnipotent, omniscient, omnivorous
ono (onym)	name	onomatopoeia, anonymous, acronym
opt	best	optimal, optimum, optimize
ortho	straight	orthodontist, orthopedic
osteo	bone	osteoporosis, osteoarthritis
ous	having	adventurous, hazardous, nauseous, joyous
out	beyond, surpass,	outgoing, outdoor, outside, outlive
over	excessive	overconfident, overstock, overexcited, overrun
oxy	sharp	oxymoron, oxidize

paleo	ancient	paleontologist, Paleolithic, paleography
pan	all	pandemic, panorama, pantheon, panacea
para	beside, related	parallel, parasite, paramedic
path	feeling, disease	pathogen, sympathetic, psychopath
pel (puls)	drive, push	dispel, repulse, compel, compulsion
ped	foot, kid	pedestrian, pedometer, pediatrician
penta	five	pentagon, pentagram, pentathlon
per	through	perception, perceive
peri	around	perimeter, peripheral
phag	to eat	esophagus, sarcophagi
phil	loving	philanthropic, philosophy
phob	fear	hydrophobia, phobia, claustrophobic
phon	sound	telephone, saxophone, microphone
photo	light	photograph, photogenic, photosynthesis
phyt	plant, to grow	hydrophyte, neophyte
pneu	air, breath	pneumonia, pneumatic
poli (polis)	city	metropolis, cosmopolitan
pop	people	population, popular
port	carry	portable, deport, portal
pos	put, place	position, compose, deposit
post	after	posterior, postpone, postmortem
pre	before	prevent, predetermined, precaution, preview
psuedo	FALSE	pseudonym, pseudoscience
psyche	mind, spirit	psychology, psychic
pugn (pung)	to fight	pugnacious, repugnant, pungent
pul	urge	compulsion, impulsive, expulsion
purg	clean	purge, purgatory, expurgate
pyr	fire	pyromaniac, pyrogen
quad	four	quadruple, quadrant, quadriplegic
quin	five	quints, quintessence
radic (radix)	root	eradicate, radical, radish
re	again	rebuild, renew, restart, reflect
reg	guide, rules	regulate, regular, regent, regime
retro	back, backward	retroactive, retrospect, retrograde
rhod	red	rhodopsin, cynorrhodon, rhodamine
rid	laugh	ridicule, ridiculous
rub	red	ruby, rubella, bilirubin
rupt	burst	rupture, disrupt, interrupt, erupt
san	health	sane, sanity, insane, sanitation
scend	climb, go	ascend, crescendo, descent
sci	to know	science, conscience, conscious, omniscient
scop	see, look	telescope, microscope
scrib	write	scribe, prescribe, inscribe, describe
se	apart	secede, seclude, serum

sect	cut	dissect, intersect, section
sed	sit	sediment, sedentary
self	of, for, by itself	self-respect, self-control, selfish, selfless
semi	half	semicircle, semicolon, semifinal
sens	feel	sensitive, consent, sentimental
serv	to save or keep	conservation, reserve, preserve
sol	comfort	consolation, solace
son	sound	consonant, supersonic
soph	wise	philosophy, sophisticated, sophism
spect	see	spectator, spectacles, inspect
sphere	ball	biosphere, hemisphere
spir	breathe	respiratory, inspirational
sta	stand	stable, stability, stagnant, stationary
stell	star	interstellar, constellation, stellar
sub	below, under	submarine, subpar
super	higher in quality o	superior, supernatural, superfan, superb
syn (sym)	with, together	synonym, sympathy
tact	to touch	contact, tactile
tax	arrangement	syntax, taxonomy, ataxia
techn (techno)	art, skill	technologic, technique
tele	far	television, telephone, telescope
temp	time	contemporary, temporary, tempo
term	end, limit	determine, terminate, exterminate, midterm
tetra	four	tetrapod, tetrarchy
theo (the)	god	theology, monotheism
tort	twist	contort, distort, retort
tox	poison	toxin, detoxification, toxicology, toxic, intoxicated
tract	pull	tractor, subtract, attract, contraction
trans	across, through	transform, transaction, translate, transport
ultra	beyond, extreme	ultrasonic, ultramodern
un	not	unfair, unable, unfriendly, uncontrollable
uni	one	unicycle, united, unison
urb	city	suburb, urban, urbanology
vac	empty	vacuum, vacant, evacuate
ven	come	venue, invent, preventative
vic (vin)	to win	victory, convince, invincible
vid (vis)	see	video, visual, video, visible
voc	call	vocalize, vocal
vor (vour)	eat	devour, voracious, carnivore, herbivore
xen	foreign	xenocide, xenophobic, xenophile
zoo	animal	zookeeper, zoology